

COURSE GUIDE · 2026 INTAKE

Bachelor of Nursing

*Care, science, and clinical practice
shaped for the decade ahead.*

DURATION

3 years full-time

CRICOS CODE

095421G

LOCATIONS

Brisbane · Online

01 · WELCOME

A degree that meets the moment.

Nursing today is shaped by data, complexity, and an unwavering commitment to human care. The Bachelor of Nursing at Northbridge prepares graduates to step into clinical environments – hospital, community, aged-care, and digital – with the confidence of deep practice and the curiosity of a lifelong learner.

Our curriculum is built in close partnership with Northbridge Health, four major tertiary hospitals across South-East Queensland, and primary care networks serving regional and remote communities. From your first semester, you will engage in simulated and supervised clinical experiences alongside the theory that anchors them.

Graduates leave equipped to register with the Nursing and Midwifery Board of Australia (NMBA) and to practise as a Registered Nurse across the full breadth of contemporary settings.

Three threads run through every year of the program – person-centred care, evidence-informed practice, and cultural and ethical responsibility. These are not modules. They are the lens through which every subject, every placement, and every assessment is designed.

You will also build digital fluency – interpreting clinical data, using electronic medical records, and understanding the role of AI and decision-support tools in safe, modern healthcare.

3yr

FULL-TIME DURATION

1,000+CLINICAL PLACEMENT
HOURS**96%**

GRADUATE EMPLOYMENT

AHPRA

REGISTRATION PATHWAY

“The strongest nurses I’ve hired all share one trait – they were taught to think clinically and systemically. Northbridge graduates consistently arrive with both.”

DR. PRIYA RAMANATHAN · DIRECTOR OF NURSING, NORTHBRIDGE HEALTH

02 · AT A GLANCE

Course essentials.

DETAIL

Award	Bachelor of Nursing (BN)
Faculty	Health Sciences
Mode of study	On-campus · Blended
Duration	3 years full-time (6 years part-time)
Intakes	February · July
Credit points	288 cp (24 units)
AQF level	Level 7 — Bachelor
CRICOS code	095421G
Annual fee (domestic CSP)	AUD \$8,948
Annual fee (international)	AUD \$34,560
Accreditation	ANMAC · NMBA approved

ENTRY REQUIREMENTS

ATAR	70.00 minimum (or equivalent)
Prerequisites	English (Units 3 & 4, C or better)
Recommended	Biology or Chemistry
English (international)	IELTS 7.0 — no band below 7.0
Inherent requirements	Met per NMBA standards
Compliance	NDIS, Blue Card, immunisation

ALTERNATIVE PATHWAYS

PATHWAY	FOR	OUTCOME
Diploma of Nursing (Enrolled Nurse)	Current ENs with AHPRA registration	Direct entry to Year 2 (96 cp credit)
Tertiary Preparation Program	Mature-age, non-school leavers	Guaranteed entry on completion
Bridging units (Health Sciences)	ATAR-near-miss applicants	Conditional entry, Feb intake
Recognition of Prior Learning	Prior healthcare qualifications	Up to 144 cp credit (case by case)

03 · STRUCTURE

What you'll study, year by year.

The program unfolds over three years and eight teaching periods. Each year builds clinical depth alongside academic rigour — culminating in a 320-hour transition-to-practice placement in the final semester.

YEAR 1

Foundations of nursing practice

Anatomy, physiology, and the science of care. First placement at the end of Semester 2 — community and aged-care settings.

NURS101 Foundations of Nursing 12 cp

HLTH102 Human Anatomy & Physiology I 12 cp

NURS103 Health Assessment & Communication 12 cp

NURS104 Indigenous Health & Cultural Safety 12 cp

HLTH105 Human Anatomy & Physiology II 12 cp

NURS106 Pharmacology for Nursing 12 cp

NURS107 Person-Centred Care Across the Lifespan 12 cp

NURS108 Clinical Practice Placement I (120 hrs) 12 cp

CLINICAL PLACEMENT 120 clinical hours · Aged-care & community settings

YEAR 2

Acute & complex care

Medical-surgical nursing, mental health, and chronic disease management. Two placements across acute and mental-health contexts.

NURS201 Medical-Surgical Nursing I 12 cp

NURS202 Pathophysiology & Clinical Reasoning 12 cp

NURS203 Mental Health Nursing 12 cp

NURS204 Clinical Practice Placement II (240 hrs) 12 cp

NURS205 Medical-Surgical Nursing II 12 cp

NURS206 Chronic Disease & Complex Care 12 cp

NURS207 Research & Evidence in Nursing 12 cp

NURS208 Clinical Practice Placement III (240 hrs) 12 cp

CLINICAL PLACEMENT 480 clinical hours · Acute medical, surgical, and mental health

YEAR 3

Specialty & transition to practice

Leadership, paediatric and maternal-child nursing, and the capstone transition placement – a sustained 320-hour clinical immersion.

NURS301 Maternal, Child & Family Health 12 cp

NURS302 Emergency & Critical Care Nursing 12 cp

NURS303 Leadership & Quality in Healthcare 12 cp

NURS304 Digital Health & Informatics 12 cp

NURS305 Capstone: Integrated Nursing Practice 12 cp

NURS306 Ethics, Law & Professional Practice 12 cp

NURS307 Elective (Rural · Global · Research) 12 cp

NURS308 Transition to Practice (320 hrs) 12 cp

CLINICAL PLACEMENT 560 clinical hours · Specialty rotations + transition placement

04 · CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Where you'll practise.

Northbridge has placement partnerships with more than 60 healthcare providers across Queensland, ensuring every student gains exposure to the breadth of modern nursing — from tertiary acute care through to remote primary health.

TERTIARY HOSPITALS	COMMUNITY & PRIMARY	SPECIALTY & RURAL
Royal Brisbane & Women's Princess Alexandra Hospital Mater Hospital Brisbane Queensland Children's Hospital	Brisbane North PHN West Moreton Primary Care Hearspace (Mental Health) Anglicare Aged Care Network	Mount Isa Base Hospital Cherbourg Aboriginal Medical Royal Flying Doctor Service Roma Rural Health Service

05 · CAREERS

Where graduates go.

96% of Bachelor of Nursing graduates secure employment within six months — most into transition-to-practice programs at their placement hospitals. Graduates work as Registered Nurses across every state and territory, and the degree opens postgraduate pathways into specialty practice.

EARLY CAREER (0–3 YRS)	MID-CAREER (3–7 YRS)	POSTGRADUATE PATHWAYS
Registered Nurse (Graduate)	Clinical Nurse Specialist	Master of Nurse Practitioner
Acute Care Nurse	Nurse Educator	Master of Mental Health Nursing
Community Health Nurse	Clinical Coordinator	Master of Midwifery
Aged Care Registered Nurse	Research Nurse	Graduate Cert. in Critical Care
Mental Health Nurse	Nurse Unit Manager	PhD / Doctor of Nursing

\$76k

GRADUATE RN — BASE SALARY

\$98k

CLINICAL NURSE SPECIALIST

\$132k

NURSE PRACTITIONER

Sample QLD median salaries, mid-2025. Source: Northbridge Graduate Outcomes Survey.

06 · FEES & KEY DATES

Plan your year.

FEE TYPE	PER YEAR	MILESTONE	DATE
Commonwealth Supported Place	AUD \$8,948	Applications open (Feb intake)	01 Aug 2025
Domestic Fee-Paying	AUD \$22,400	QTAC preference deadline	29 Sep 2025
International (on-shore)	AUD \$34,560	Offers released	21 Jan 2026
Student services & amenities	AUD \$326	Orientation week	16–20 Feb 2026
Compliance & placement	AUD \$410 (one-off)	Semester 1 begins	23 Feb 2026

Domestic students may defer Commonwealth-supported fees through HECS-HELP. Scholarships are available for rural, Indigenous, and equity students — see the Tarelium Scholarship Portal for full details.

07 · HOW TO APPLY

Four steps to enrolment.

- 01 Check you qualify**

Review entry requirements and inherent requirements for nursing. If you're unsure, our admissions team will help you map the right pathway.
- 02 Submit through QTAC or directly**

Domestic applicants apply via QTAC (course code 717031). International applicants apply directly through Northbridge Apply.
- 03 Complete compliance pre-clinical**

Once offered a place, you'll complete immunisation, Blue Card, National Police Check, and NDIS Worker Screening before placement.
- 04 Enrol and orient**

Confirm your offer, enrol in Year 1 units, and join Orientation Week — where you'll meet your cohort, advisors, and clinical educators.

08 · SCHOLARSHIPS & SUPPORT

More than a degree.

Financial barriers should never decide a future nurse's career. Northbridge offers a broad portfolio of scholarships and dedicated student support — from your first orientation through to graduation and registration.

SCHOLARSHIP	VALUE	ELIGIBILITY
Nursing Excellence Award	\$10,000 / year	ATAR 90+, all years
Rural & Regional Pathway	\$8,000 / year	Students from postcodes outside SEQ metro
Indigenous Health Future Fund	\$12,000 / year	Aboriginal & Torres Strait Islander students
Equity & Access Bursary	\$5,000 / year	Means-tested, applied annually
Industry Placement Stipend	\$3,500 / placement	Rural & remote placements only

ACADEMIC SUPPORT	WELLBEING	CAREER & PLACEMENT
Personal academic advisor Peer-led study groups Drop-in maths & writing clinic Library research librarians	Free confidential counselling Aboriginal & Torres Strait Islander unit Disability & accessibility services On-campus medical clinic	Dedicated clinical placement team Career mentoring with industry RNs CV, interview & AHPRA preparation Lifetime alumni network access

READY TO START?

Talk with our admissions
team.

EMAIL

nursing.admissions@
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PHONE

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